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state legislature - 8 vie for vacant spot in 45th - Here's a rundown of candidates seeking to fill Assembly seat vacated by Matt Dababneh

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Here's a voters' guide to the eight candidates running in Tuesday's special electionto fill the remaining months of Matt Dababneh's term representing the 45th Assembly District, which covers the west San Fernando Valley communities of Calabasas, Hidden Hills, Canoga Park, Woodland Hills, West Hills, Winnetka, Northridge, Reseda, Tarzana and Encino and the Ventura County community of Bell Canyon. Dababneh resigned because of sexual misconduct allegations. Candidates are listed in randomly selected ballot order. (A voters' guide for the special election in the 39th Assembly District, in the northeast San Fernando Valley, appeared in Sunday's Daily News.)

Justin Clark

Party: Republican

Background: The lone Republican in the race, running "to restore common sense to Sacramento," is an 18-year-old Cal State Northridge student who works in an ice cream shop. "I do not have some long history in public service," his website says.

Backers: Clark does not list endorsements, and staff officials list no fundraising reports for his campaign.

Big idea: Clark says he will put constituents' interests first and complains that "Sacramento is plagued by corruption and those whose first duty is to special interest groups or their party."

Website: www.votejustinclark.com

Tricia Robbins Kasson

Party: Democratic

Background: An aide to Los Angeles City Councilman Bob Blumenfield, Robbins Kasson has played a role in revitalization of commercial corridors in Canoga Park and Reseda, and touts her experience on issues of community planning, transportation and housing.

Backers: Robbins Kasson has a long list of

endorsements from state lawmakers, L.A. City Council members and women's political groups.

Big idea: The only woman in this race, Robbins Kasson says electing more women to positions of power is needed to change a culture of sexual harassment in California government. "I believe when you have more women who are part of the conversations, it shifts the conversations," she said.

Website: www.tricia4 assembly.com

Jesse Gabriel

Party: Democratic

Background: Gabriel, a constitutional rights and general litigation attorney with Gibson, Dunn & Crutcher, has worked on lawsuits to protect undocumented young people known as “Dreamers” from Trump administration efforts to roll back DACA protections.

Backers: Gabriel’s big endorsements come from the Democratic Party of the San Fernando Valley and an array of L.A.-area Democratic members of Congress.

Big idea: Gabriel’s calling card is his work on lawsuits against the Trump administration, more than promises about specifically local issues. “We must stand up to the Trump administration to protect our people and our planet,” he says in a campaign mailer.

Website: https://jesse forassembly.com

Ankur Patel

Party: Democratic

Background: An aide to an L.A. Unified school board member, Patel calls himself “the education candidate.” He also has worked with health care workers and tenants unions and environmental groups. He ran for the school board in 2015.

Backers: Patel’s big endorsements come from progressive Democratic groups and teachers unions. His biggest campaign donation comes from the California Nurses Association.

Big idea: Patel presents himself as the candidate for Bernie Sanders (progressive) Democrats. He wholeheartedly supports a single-payer health care system for California, disagreeing with those who say the state has no way to pay for it.

Website: https://ankur forassembly.com

Daniel Brin

Party: Democratic

Background: President of the West Hills Neighborhood Council, Brin is a journalist who produces publications for labor unions and health plan trust funds, and earlier ran Jewish community newspapers.

Backers: Brin lists no endorsements or campaign contributions.

Big idea: Brin wants to bring the west San Fernando Valley its share of government resources. He complains that the Valley has been “neglected and despised” when it comes to funding for mass transit and arts projects.

Website: http://danielbrin .com

Jeff Bornstein

Party: Democratic

Background: Bornstein owns an electronics company. He previously ran for the L.A. City Council and for city controller.

Backers: Bornstein does not claim endorsements and has not reported campaign donations.

Big idea: A self-proclaimed “sensible Democrat,” Bornstein would cancel California’s bullet train project and use the

money to fund a single-payer health care system.

Website: none.

Ray Bishop

Party: Democratic

Background: Bishop has owned a variety of small businesses over the years, including a comedy club in Encino, and has been a film producer.

Backers: Bishop does not claim endorsements. His campaign donations come from individuals.

Big idea: When candidates at a February forum discussed solutions to California government's sexual harassment scandals, Bishop said one big problem is a lack of "moral leadership" from the Trump administration.

Website: Bishop does not have a campaign website.

Dennis Zine

Party: Zine lists no party preference

Background: An L.A. city councilman representing the west Valley from 2001 to 2013, Zine announced Feb. 12 he was withdrawing from the Assembly race. But his name could not be removed from the ballot. He is not campaigning, and he is not entered in the June 5 primary for the next full term. But he said that if voters choose him, he would serve the rest of Dababneh's term.

Backers: Zine could draw support from conservative voters; he has been registered as both a Republican and an independent while serving in nonpartisan city office.

Big idea: Although he says he isn't campaigning, Zine said in an interview, "I look at the state and the trouble with taxation and homelessness. I'm the only candidate without a party affiliation, so I'd work with both parties."

Website: none.

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